Joining tables for reports

Data engineering · Level 3 · Lesson 4



Today we will

- Join tables with JOIN … ON.
- Choose an inner or a left join, and find who’s missing.
- Write reports that show only what each reader needs.

Remember

- Inner joins drop rows with no match.
- LEFT JOIN … IS NULL finds who’s missing.
- A report shows only what its reader needs.

A report for one reader

1. Warm-up (5 min): Who reads our reports?
2. Teach (8 min): Inner and left joins.
3. Sort (12 min): Column cards for three readers.
4. Write (10 min): One reader’s query.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): What did nobody need?

Use made-up tables on the board. The discussion of health notes can be sensitive: keep it general, about kinds of data, not about any real pupil.

Let’s discuss

1. Why did Zara vanish from the inner join?
2. How would you find every pupil who missed a test?
3. Which columns should never be in a marks report?

Exit ticket

- Write the SELECT and FROM lines of a report for parents, and say which join you'd use and why.